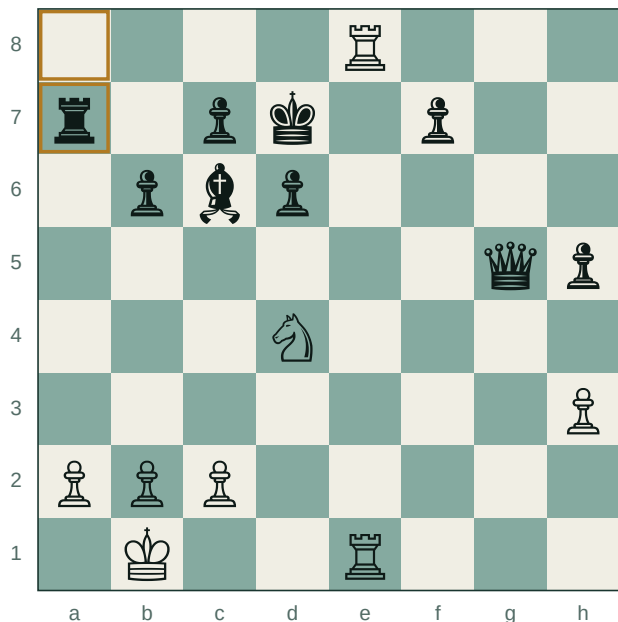


Attraction tactics: White, move 33

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 32...Rxa7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33. R1e7+ Qxe7 34. Rxe7+ Kxe7 35. Nxc6+ Kd7 36. Nxa7

33.R1e7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **33...Qxe7**.

34.Rxe7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on e7. Recorded reply: **34...Kxe7**.

35.Nxc6+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From c6 it attacks king on e7 and rook on a7. Recorded reply: **35...Kd7**.

36.Nxa7 The knight captures the rook on a7.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +7. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +7:** the balance goes from -5 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on d7. Geometrically undefended: rook on a7 and queen on g5. Check for tactical protection.